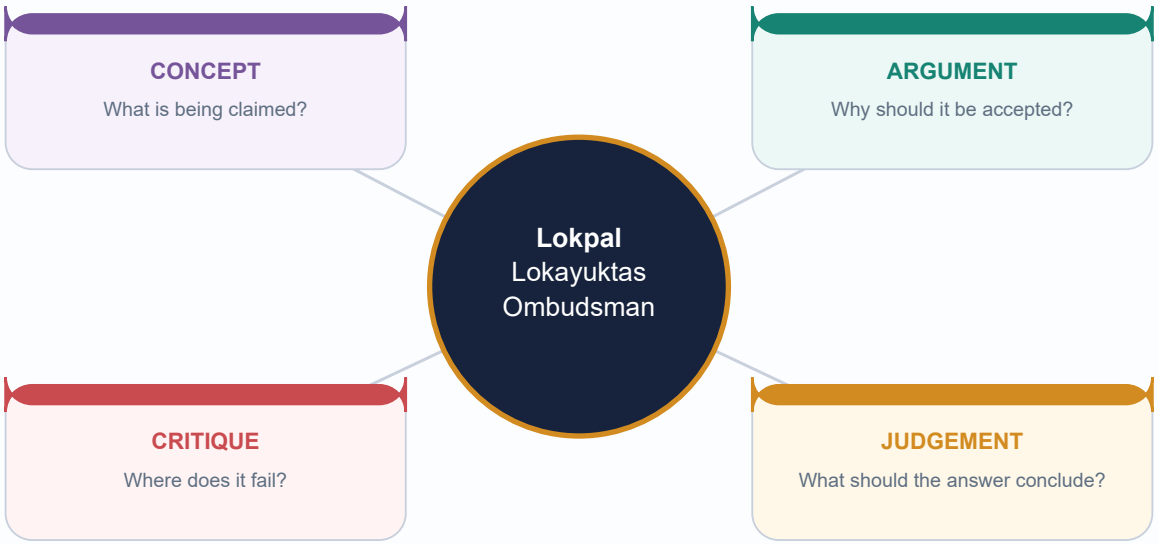
UPSC INDIAN POLITY

Lokpal & Lokayuktas — The Ombudsman in India — ADVANCED / COMPLETE Deep-Learning Visual Notes

Indian Polity · GS Paper II · Prelims + Mains
Layer 1: Basic foundation · Layer 2: Advanced constitutional and exam depth
Sources: Lokpal-and-Lokayuktas.md + 38_Lokpal-and-Lokayuktas.md
Learning cards: 38



Facts from official sources | Inferences clearly marked | No fabricated data

HIGH UPSC RELEVANCE

HIGH

Foundation · Core Foundation

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Subject: Polity · **Tier:** Basic (foundation) · **GS-II**

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

STATIC THEORY

- □ = from book · □ = current link · □ = mnemonic. *Advanced: optional deeper detail in advanced/38_Lokpal-and-Lokayuktas.md — not required for any mark.*

MEMORY HOOK

□ = from book · □ = current link · = mnemonic. *Advanced: optional deeper detail in advanced/38_Lokpal-and-Lokayuktas.md — not required for any mark.*

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. = from book · □ = current link · □ = mnemonic. *Advanced: optional deeper detail in advanced/38_Lokpal-and-Lokayuktas.md — not required for any mark.*

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK
Lokpal & Lokayuktas — The Ombudsman in India — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Core Foundation

HIGH

Foundation · Snapshot

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured comparison from the foundation source layer.

KEY DATA

Item	Fact
Law	**Lokpal and Lokayuktas Act, 2013**
Nature	**Statutory** (not constitutional)
Lokpal	**Chairperson + max 8 members** (50% judicial)
Selection	PM + Speaker + LoP(LS) + CJI/SC judge + eminent jurist
Lokayukta	State-level institution; design varies under each **state law**
Ombudsman origin	**Sweden, 1809**

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK
Lokpal & Lokayuktas — The Ombudsman in India — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Snapshot

HIGH

Foundation · Core idea

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

The **Lokpal** (Centre) and **Lokayukta** (states) are India's **anti-corruption ombudsmen**, recommended by the **First ARC** and finally enacted in **2013** after the **Anna Hazare movement**. Lokpal covers the **PM (with exclusions), Ministers, MPs and all govt officials**, and can **direct the CBI** in referred cases.

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

CORE IDEA: RECALL MAP

Core idea

V

Dimension 1 The Lokpal (Centre) and Lokayukta (states) are India's anti-corruption ombudsmen, recommended by the First ARC and finally enacted in 2013 after the A	**Dimension 2** □ Lokpal: Chair + 8 members, 50% judicial, 50% SC/ST/OBC/min/women.
Dimension 3 □ Biggest weakness: NO suo-motu power; no anonymous complaints; 7-yr limitation.	**Dimension 4** □ Lokpal has a uniform central statute; Lokayukta appointment, composition,

STATIC THEORY

- □ **Lokpal:** Chair + **8** members, **50% judicial**, **50%** SC/ST/OBC/min/women.

- □ Biggest weakness: **NO suo-motu power**; **no anonymous** complaints; **7-yr** limitation.

- □ Lokpal has a uniform central statute; **Lokayukta appointment, composition,

- jurisdiction and tenure vary across state enactments**.

MEMORY HOOK

Lokpal: Chair + 8 members, 50% judicial, 50% SC/ST/OBC/min/women. | Biggest weakness: NO suo-motu power; no anonymous complaints; 7-yr limitation. | Lokpal has a uniform central statute; **Lokayukta appointment, composition,

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Lokpal & Lokayuktas — The Ombudsman in India — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Core idea

HIGH

Foundation · Must-Know Facts

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

□ **10 bills** introduced (1968–2011) before the 2013 Act.

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MUST-KNOW FACTS: RECALL MAP

Must-Know Facts

V

Dimension 1 □ 10 bills introduced (1968–2011) before the 2013 Act.	**Dimension 2** □ ARC kept the judiciary outside Lokpal; PM included with safeguards.
Dimension 3 □ Maharashtra was the first state to establish a Lokayukta (1971). Do not universalise	**Dimension 4** one state's selection panel, age limit or tenure to all Lokayuktas.

STATIC THEORY

- □ ARC kept the **judiciary outside** Lokpal; PM **included with safeguards**.
- □ Maharashtra was the first state to establish a Lokayukta (1971). Do not universalise
- one state's selection panel, age limit or tenure to all Lokayuktas.
- □ Lokpal has **superintendence over the CBI** for referred cases.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. **10 bills** introduced (1968–2011) before the 2013 Act.
2. ARC kept the **judiciary outside** Lokpal; PM **included with safeguards**.
3. Maharashtra was the first state to establish a Lokayukta (1971). Do not universalise
4. Lokpal has **superintendence over the CBI** for referred cases.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Lokpal & Lokayuktas — The Ombudsman in India — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Must-Know Facts

HIGH

Foundation · □ Current link

GS-II Indian Polity

NEWS TRIGGER

□ □ **Justice A.M. Khanwilkar** has chaired the Lokpal since **10 Mar 2024** (official Lokpal profile); first chair was **Justice P.C. Ghose (2019)**. □ □ On **20 Feb 2025**, the Supreme Court stayed the Lokpal's 27 Jan 2025 order asserting jurisdiction over a High Court judge; the jurisdiction issue therefore remains unsettled, not a final expansion of Lokpal power.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Exam-ready treatment of □ Current link.

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Lokpal & Lokayuktas — The Ombudsman in India — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → □ Current link

HIGH

Foundation · Answer architecture (10/15/20-mark support)

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Exam-ready treatment of Answer architecture (10/15/20-mark support).

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MAINS ANGLE

*Purpose: make this Core file independently able to answer directive-sensitive GS-II questions on the ombudsman idea, the Lokpal's design, jurisdiction (including the Prime Minister), its structural weaknesses and the State-level variation of Lokayuktas — and the routed **2025 Prelims demand on jurisdiction and composition** — without opening Advanced. No Mains PYQ is routed to this file, so §5 leads with the architecture grid (§5.4) and the jurisdiction/composition banks the objective demand needs.*

STUDY LINK

Lokpal & Lokayuktas — The Ombudsman in India — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Answer architecture (10/15/20-mark support)

HIGH

Foundation · 5.1 Demand and directive map

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured comparison from the foundation source layer.

KEY DATA

Demand family	Typical directive signals	Answer spine to use
Lokpal design and jurisdiction	"ombudsman", "covers the PM?", Discuss	Origin → composition → jurisdiction incl. PM safeguards → verdict
Structural weaknesses	"toothless ombudsman", "no suo-motu", Critically examine	Named drawbacks → reliance on CBI → reforms → verdict
Lokayukta variation	"why do States differ?", Examine	Section 63 mandate → State-law design → uneven outcomes
Anti-corruption architecture	"Lokpal vs CVC vs CBI", Comment	Map roles → overlap → coordination → verdict
Effectiveness since 2019	"has the Lokpal delivered?", Analyse	Appointments → jurisdiction disputes → capacity → caution
Prior approval / sanction	"Section 17A", Analyse	PC-Act 2018 approval → effect on Lokpal-referred probes

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Lokpal & Lokayuktas — The Ombudsman in India — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 5.1 Demand and directive map

HIGH

Foundation · 5.2 Qualified thesis options

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

The Lokpal is a long-delayed institutional answer to a structural problem — it took forty-five years and ten Bills from the First ARC to the 2013 Act — but its design built in the very caution that limits it: no suo-motu power and dependence on the CBI.

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

5.2 QUALIFIED THESIS OPTIONS: RECALL MAP

5.2 Qualified thesis options

V

Dimension 1 The Lokpal is a long-delayed institutional answer to a structural problem — it took forty-five years and ten Bills from the First ARC to the 2013 Act	**Dimension 2** Bringing the Prime Minister within the Lokpal's ambit was a real advance in accountability; hedging it with subject-matter exclusions and a two-thirds
Dimension 3 The Lokpal's weakness is not its statute but its dependence: with no investigative machinery of its own it must borrow the CBI, so its independence is	**Dimension 4** Leaving Lokayukta design entirely to the States produced accountability by postcode — a strong ombudsman in one State and a dormant one in another — w

STATIC THEORY

- Bringing the Prime Minister within the Lokpal's ambit was a real advance in accountability; hedging it with subject-matter exclusions and a two-thirds-bench safeguard was the price of making that inclusion politically acceptable.

- The Lokpal's weakness is not its statute but its dependence: with no investigative machinery of its own it must borrow the CBI, so its independence is only as real as the agency it relies on.

- Leaving Lokayukta design entirely to the States produced accountability by postcode — a strong ombudsman in one State and a dormant one in another — which is the cost of that federal flexibility.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Lokpal & Lokayuktas — The Ombudsman in India — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 5.2 Qualified thesis options

HIGH

Foundation · 5.3 Mark-scaled structures

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured comparison from the foundation source layer.

KEY DATA

Marks	Architecture	Evidence load
10	Thesis → composition + jurisdiction (incl. PM) → one drawback → verdict	3 units, at least one Section
15	Thesis → origin → design and jurisdiction → drawbacks and CBI-dependence → reforms → verdict	5–6 units
20	Thesis → ombudsman origin → architecture → jurisdiction with PM safeguards → machinery and PC-Act sanction → Lokayukta variation → graded verdict	6–8 units + a "why it under-delivers" paragraph

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Lokpal & Lokayuktas — The Ombudsman in India — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 5.3 Mark-scaled structures

HIGH

Foundation · 5.4 Bank A — Statutory-body architecture on the eight comparable heads · Table 1.1

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured comparison from the foundation source layer.

KEY DATA

Head	Lokpal (Centre)	Lokayukta (States)
□ **Legal source**	**Lokpal and Lokayuktas Act, 2013** (statutory; recommended by the **First ARC, 1966–70**; ombudsman idea from **Sweden, 1809**)	Established by **each State's own law** under **Section 63** of the 2013 Act — design left to the State
□ **Appointment authority**	**President**	**Governor** (typically; varies by State)
□ **Selection committee**	**PM (chair) + Speaker (Lok Sabha) + LoP (Lok Sabha) + CJI or an SC judge + one eminent jurist** (President-nominated on the first four's advice); a **Search Committee** assists	□□ **Varies by State** — no uniform panel
□ **Composition**	**Chairperson + maximum 8 members**, of whom **50% (up to 4) are judicial members**; **not less than 50% of members from SC/ST/OBC/minorities/women**	□□ **Varies** — some States have an **Upalokayukta**; some are single-member
□ **Tenure**	**5 years or age 70**, whichever earlier; service conditions are statutorily aligned with the **CJI/Supreme Court judge** benchmarks	□□ **Varies by State statute**
□ **Removal**	For proved misbehaviour, by the **President** after Supreme Court inquiry on a statutory reference; specified direct-removal grounds follow a separate route	□□ **Varies by State statute**
□ **Powers (binding?)**	Orders preliminary inquiry/investigation, **directs the CBI and other agencies**, grants **sanction for prosecution**, can **attach/confiscate** proceeds; **NO suo-motu power**	□□ Mostly **recommendatory** to the Governor/Government; varies
□ **Appeal / enforcement limit**	**No independent investigation machinery of its own** — relies on its Inquiry Wing and the **CBI**; **7-year limitation** on complaints; a PM inquiry needs a **two-thirds full-bench approval** and excludes named subjects	□□ Varies; often weak enforcement

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Lokpal & Lokayuktas — The Ombudsman in India — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 5.4 Bank A — Statutory-body architecture on the eight comparable heads

HIGH

Foundation · 5.4 Bank A — Statutory-body architecture on the eight comparable heads · Table 1.2

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured comparison from the foundation source layer.

KEY DATA

Head	Lokpal (Centre)	Lokayukta (States)
□ **Independence safeguards**	Fixed tenure, SC-inquiry removal, and **CBI officers investigating Lokpal-referred cases cannot be transferred without Lokpal approval**	□□ Varies by State
□ **Accountability route**	Independent body subject to **judicial review**; removal only via the SC reference — not under any line ministry	□□ Reports to the Governor/State Legislature, per State law

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Lokpal & Lokayuktas — The Ombudsman in India — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 5.4 Bank A — Statutory-body architecture on the eight comparable heads

HIGH

Foundation · 5.4 Bank A — Statutory-body architecture on the eight comparable heads

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured comparison from the foundation source layer.

KEY DATA

Milestone	What happened
□ **1809**	The **ombudsman** office originates in **Sweden**
□ **1966–70**	The **First ARC** recommends a **Lokpal (Centre)** and **Lokayukta (States)**
□ **1968 → 2011**	**Ten** Lokpal Bills introduced and lapsed
□ **2011**	The **Anna Hazare / India Against Corruption** movement forces the issue
□ **2013 / 2014**	The **Lokpal and Lokayuktas Act, 2013** is enacted (commenced 16 Jan 2014)
□ **2019**	The **first Lokpal** (Justice P.C. Ghose) is appointed after the LoP-vacancy delay

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK
Lokpal & Lokayuktas — The Ombudsman in India — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 5.4 Bank A — Statutory-body architecture on the eight comparable heads

HIGH

Foundation · 5.4 Bank A — Statutory-body architecture on the eight comparable heads

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Analytical use: the "toothless ombudsman" answer sits in rows 7–8 (no suo-motu, no own investigators, CBI-dependence); the "covers the PM" answer sits in the jurisdiction bank (§5.5).

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

STATIC THEORY

- **Evolution (cite to anchor the "why it took so long" framing):**

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK
Lokpal & Lokayuktas — The Ombudsman in India — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 5.4 Bank A — Statutory-body architecture on the eight comparable heads

HIGH

Foundation · 5.5 Bank B — Jurisdiction, including the Prime Minister (the routed "jurisdiction" limb)

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Claim: the Lokpal's reach is deliberately wide across public servants. **Evidence:** it covers the **PM, Ministers, MPs and Groups A, B, C and D** officials, plus bodies covered by the government-finance/control clauses and specified foreign-contribution recipients above the statutory threshold. **Significance:** it is a broad but conditional jurisdiction. **Limitation:** section 14(2) preserves Article 105(2) for genuine speech/vote functions, while *Sita Soren* confirms that bribery is not immunised merely because it relates to a vote.

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

5.5 BANK B — JURISDICTION, INCLUDING THE PRIME MINISTER (THE ROUTED "JURISDICTION" LIMB): RECALL MAP

5.5 Bank B — Jurisdiction, including the Prime Minister (the routed "jurisdiction" limb)

V

Dimension 1 Claim: the Lokpal's reach is deliberately wide across public servants. Evidence: it covers the PM, Ministers, MPs and Groups A, B, C and D officials,	**Dimension 2** Claim: the PM is included but ring-fenced. Evidence: the Lokpal can inquire into the PM, except for allegations relating to international relations, e
Dimension 3 Claim: its reach into the higher judiciary is unsettled. Evidence: □ on 20 Feb 2025 the Supreme Court stayed the Lokpal's 27 Jan 2025 order asserting	

STATIC THEORY

- **Claim:** the PM is included but ring-fenced. **Evidence:** the Lokpal **can inquire into the PM**, **except** for allegations relating to **international relations, external and internal security, public order, atomic energy and space**; any such inquiry must be held **in-camera** and needs the approval of a **full bench with at least a two-thirds majority**. **Significance:** inclusion of the head of government was the headline reform of 2013. **Limitation/status caution:** the exclusions and the super-majority safeguard make a PM inquiry hard to initiate.

- **Claim:** its reach into the higher judiciary is unsettled. **Evidence:** □ on **20 Feb 2025** the **Supreme Court stayed** the Lokpal's **27 Jan 2025** order asserting jurisdiction over a **High Court judge**. **Significance:** the judiciary question is live. **Limitation/status:** □□ the stayed order is **not settled law** — do not present it as an expansion of Lokpal power.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Lokpal & Lokayuktas — The Ombudsman in India — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 5.5 Bank B — Jurisdiction, including the Prime Minister (the routed "jurisdiction" limb)

HIGH

Foundation · 5.6 Bank C — Composition, selection and reservation (the routed "composition" limb)

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Claim: the bench is capped and half-judicial. **Evidence: Chairperson + maximum 8 members**; **50% must be judicial members** (a judicial member being a former SC judge or former HC Chief Justice); the Chairperson is a **former CJI / former SC judge / eminent person of integrity**. **Significance:** the judicial weighting signals a quasi-adjudicatory body. **Limitation:** a large bench has proved slow to constitute and staff.

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

5.6 BANK C — COMPOSITION, SELECTION AND RESERVATION (THE ROUTED "COMPOSITION" LIMB): RECALL MAP

5.6 Bank C — Composition, selection and reservation (the routed "composition" limb)

V

Dimension 1 Claim: the bench is capped and half-judicial. Evidence: Chairperson + maximum 8 members; 50% must be judicial members (a judicial member being a forme	**Dimension 2** Claim: the composition is socially representative by law. Evidence: not less than 50% of members must be from SC/ST/OBC/minorities/women. Significance
Dimension 3 Claim: the selection process mixes the executive, legislature, judiciary and an independent voice. Evidence: the five-member Selection Committee — PM,	

STATIC THEORY

- **Claim:** the composition is socially representative by law. **Evidence: not less than 50% of members** must be from **SC/ST/OBC/minorities/women**. **Significance:** a statutory diversity mandate rare among oversight bodies. **Limitation:** it constrains the pool and complicates appointments.

- **Claim:** the selection process mixes the executive, legislature, judiciary and an independent voice. **Evidence:** the five-member **Selection Committee** — **PM, Speaker, LoP, CJI/SC judge and an eminent jurist** — with a **Search Committee** to shortlist. **Significance:** designed to dilute executive dominance in appointments. **Limitation/status:** □□ the first appointment occurred only in **2019**; *Common Cause* (2017) had already held that the LoP vacancy did not make the Act unworkable or create a largest-opposition-party substitute.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK
Lokpal & Lokayuktas — The Ombudsman in India — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 5.6 Bank C — Composition, selection and reservation (the routed "composition" limb)

HIGH

Foundation · 5.7 Bank D — Machinery, CBI-dependence and the prosecution sanction

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Claim: the Lokpal has wings but no police force. **Evidence:** the Act provides an **Inquiry Wing** (preliminary inquiry) and a **Prosecution Wing** (to prosecute in special courts), but **no independent investigating agency** — investigation of referred cases is done by the **CBI** or other agencies. **Significance:** this is the structural root of its dependence. **Limitation:** its effectiveness is tied to the CBI's own autonomy problems.

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

5.7 BANK D — MACHINERY, CBI-DEPENDENCE AND THE PROSECUTION SANCTION: RECALL MAP

5.7 Bank D — Machinery, CBI-dependence and the prosecution sanction

V

Dimension 1 Claim: the Lokpal has wings but no police force. Evidence: the Act provides an Inquiry Wing (preliminary inquiry) and a Prosecution Wing (to prosecute	**Dimension 2** Claim: the Lokpal was meant to insulate the CBI in its cases. Evidence: CBI officers investigating Lokpal-referred matters cannot be transferred witho
Dimension 3 Claim: a prior-approval hurdle now sits in front of corruption probes. Evidence: the Prevention of Corruption Act, 1988, as amended in 2018, inserted	

STATIC THEORY

- **Claim:** the Lokpal was meant to insulate the CBI in its cases. **Evidence:** CBI officers investigating **Lokpal-referred** matters **cannot be transferred without the Lokpal's approval**, and the Lokpal exercises superintendence over such cases. **Significance:** a partial answer to the "caged parrot" critique. **Limitation:** it applies only to referred cases, not to the CBI generally.

- **Claim:** a prior-approval hurdle now sits in front of corruption probes. **Evidence:** the **Prevention of Corruption Act, 1988, as amended in 2018**, inserted **Section 17A**, requiring **prior approval** of the competent authority before any inquiry/investigation into a decision or recommendation taken by a public servant in official functions (except on-the-spot bribery). **Significance:** it affects Lokpal-referred and CBI investigations alike. **Limitation/status caution:** state the operative requirement; do not add an unverified current-litigation outcome.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK
Lokpal & Lokayuktas — The Ombudsman in India — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 5.7 Bank D — Machinery, CBI-dependence and the prosecution sanction

HIGH

Foundation · 5.8 Institutional incentives, mechanism and consequences

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

□□ **No suo-motu power** means the Lokpal cannot open cases on its own initiative even where corruption is notorious — it must await a complaint in the prescribed form, which caps its proactivity.

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

5.8 INSTITUTIONAL INCENTIVES, MECHANISM AND CONSEQUENCES: RECALL MAP

5.8 Institutional incentives, mechanism and consequences

V

Dimension 1 □□ No suo-motu power means the Lokpal cannot open cases on its own initiative even where corruption is notorious — it must await a complaint in the pr	**Dimension 2** □□ Dependence on the CBI transmits the CBI's own autonomy deficit into the Lokpal's work: an ombudsman that cannot investigate is only as strong as th
Dimension 3 □□ Leaving Lokayukta design to the States (Section 63, one-year mandate) produced wide variation — robust commissions in some States, dormant or under	

STATIC THEORY

- □□ **Dependence on the CBI** transmits the CBI's own autonomy deficit into the Lokpal's work: an ombudsman that cannot investigate is only as strong as the agency it must borrow.

- □□ **Leaving Lokayukta design to the States** (Section 63, one-year mandate) produced wide variation — robust commissions in some States, dormant or under-empowered ones in others — so anti-corruption cover is uneven across the federation.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Lokpal & Lokayuktas — The Ombudsman in India — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 5.8 Institutional incentives, mechanism and consequences

HIGH

Foundation · 5.9 Criticism, counter-argument, variation and implementation constraints

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured comparison from the foundation source layer.

KEY DATA

Weakness (named)	Reform	Status caution
□ No suo-motu power	Empower the Lokpal to initiate inquiries on its own cognisance	□□ Requires amendment
□ No own investigators	A **dedicated investigation wing** independent of the CBI	□□ Proposal; resource-heavy
□ Uneven Lokayuktas (Section 63)	A **model State Lokayukta law** for baseline uniformity	□□ States retain design autonomy
□ Diluted asset declaration (2016)	Restore a firm, time-bound disclosure format	□□ Executive-rule dependent
□ Higher-judiciary ambiguity	Legislative clarity after the 2025 SC stay	□□ Sub judice — do not pre-judge

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK
Lokpal & Lokayuktas — The Ombudsman in India — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 5.9 Criticism, counter-argument, variation and implementation constraints

HIGH

Foundation · 5.9 Criticism, counter-argument, variation and implementation constraints

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

"Ombudsman without teeth" critique: □□ no suo-motu power, form-over-substance complaint rules, no anonymous complaints, heavy penalties for false complaints, a **7-year** limitation and a non-transparent PM-complaint procedure blunt the institution.

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

5.9 CRITICISM, COUNTER-ARGUMENT, VARIATION AND IMPLEMENTATION CONSTRAINTS: RECALL MAP

5.9 Criticism, counter-argument, variation and implementation constraints

V

Dimension 1 "Ombudsman without teeth" critique: □□ no suo-motu power, form-over-substance complaint rules, no anonymous complaints, heavy penalties for false comp	**Dimension 2** Counter: □□ the Lokpal's jurisdiction over the PM and all officials, its power to sanction prosecution and attach proceeds, and its control over CBI o
Dimension 3 Variation: □□ Lokayukta strength varies sharply by State; a strong central Lokpal does not guarantee an effective State ombudsman.	**Dimension 4** Implementation constraints: □□ delayed appointments (no Lokpal chair until 2019), staffing and infrastructure gaps, the unresolved higher-judiciary qu

STATIC THEORY

- **Counter:** □□ the Lokpal's jurisdiction over the PM and all officials, its power to sanction prosecution and attach proceeds, and its control over CBI officers in referred cases are real teeth by design.

- **Variation:** □□ Lokayukta strength varies sharply by State; a strong central Lokpal does not guarantee an effective State ombudsman.

- **Implementation constraints:** □□ delayed appointments (no Lokpal chair until 2019), staffing and infrastructure gaps, the unresolved higher-judiciary question (2025 SC stay), and the **Section 17A** prior-approval hurdle all limit delivery; the **2016 amendment** eased the **asset-declaration** mandate (amending **Section 44** to let the Centre prescribe the form/manner), which critics read as a dilution of transparency.

- **Reform map (for a "suggest reforms" limb on this heavily-examinable topic):**

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Lokpal & Lokayuktas — The Ombudsman in India — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 5.9 Criticism, counter-argument, variation and implementation constraints

HIGH

Foundation · 5.10 Verdict scaffolds

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Design verdict: "The 2013 Act built a broad-jurisdiction ombudsman and then hedged it — no suo-motu power, no own investigators, a super-majority safeguard for PM inquiries — so its promise depends on reforms that give it teeth without politicising it."

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

5.10 VERDICT SCAFFOLDS: RECALL MAP

5.10 Verdict scaffolds

V

Dimension 1 Design verdict: "The 2013 Act built a broad-jurisdiction ombudsman and then hedged it — no suo-motu power, no own investigators, a super-majority safe	**Dimension 2** PM-jurisdiction verdict: "Including the Prime Minister was the reform's real achievement; the subject-matter exclusions and the two-thirds-bench safeg
Dimension 3 Federal verdict: "By leaving Lokayuktas to State law, the Act traded uniformity for federal flexibility and got uneven ombudsman cover — the case for	

STATIC THEORY

- **PM-jurisdiction verdict:** "Including the Prime Minister was the reform's real achievement; the subject-matter exclusions and the two-thirds-bench safeguard make that inclusion meaningful yet cautious, not symbolic yet not unchecked."

- **Federal verdict:** "By leaving Lokayuktas to State law, the Act traded uniformity for federal flexibility and got uneven ombudsman cover — the case for a model State law is strong."

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Lokpal & Lokayuktas — The Ombudsman in India — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 5.10 Verdict scaffolds

HIGH

Foundation · 5.11 Prelims close-option distinctions (answers the routed 2025 objective demand on jurisdiction and composition) · Table 1.1

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured comparison from the foundation source layer.

KEY DATA

Confusion pair	Correct discrimination
Lokpal constitutional vs statutory	**Statutory** — Lokpal and Lokayuktas Act, **2013**; never constitutional
Composition cap	**Chairperson + maximum 8 members**; **50% (up to 4) judicial**; **not less than 50% from SC/ST/OBC/minorities/women**
Selection committee	**PM + Speaker (LS) + LoP (LS) + CJI/SC judge + an eminent jurist** — five members
Does it cover the PM?	**Yes, with exclusions** (international relations, security, public order, atomic energy, space) and a **two-thirds full-bench** safeguard
MPs' conduct	Section 14(2) preserves genuine **speech/vote functions**, but bribery is not privileged after *Sita Soren*
Suo-motu power	The Lokpal has **NO suo-motu power** — a key drawback
Complaint limitation	**7 years** from the alleged offence
Own investigators?	**No** — it relies on its Inquiry Wing and the **CBI**

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Lokpal & Lokayuktas — The Ombudsman in India — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 5.11 Prelims close-option distinctions (answers the routed 2025 objective demand on jurisdiction and composition)

HIGH

Foundation · 5.11 Prelims close-option distinctions (answers the routed 2025 objective demand on jurisdiction and composition) · Table 1.2

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured comparison from the foundation source layer.

KEY DATA

Confusion pair	Correct discrimination
Ombudsman origin	**Sweden, 1809**; recommended for India by the **First ARC**
Lokayukta uniformity	**No** — design **varies by State** (Section 63); do not universalise one State's panel/tenure
Coverage of NGOs/trusts	Bodies **receiving foreign contribution above ₹10 lakh/year** and those **wholly or partly government-financed** are covered
Prosecution machinery	The Lokpal has an **Inquiry Wing** and a **Prosecution Wing** and can grant **sanction for prosecution**

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Lokpal & Lokayuktas — The Ombudsman in India — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 5.11 Prelims close-option distinctions (answers the routed 2025 objective demand on jurisdiction and composition)

HIGH

Foundation · 5.12 Factual-risk and current-status controls

GS-II Indian Polity

NEWS TRIGGER

 Lokpal is **statutory** (2013 Act); composition is **Chairperson + max 8 members (50% judicial)** — do not state unlimited members. The PM **is** within jurisdiction **with** the named exclusions and the **two-thirds-bench** safeguard — do not say the PM is wholly excluded or wholly included. The Lokpal has **no suo-motu power** and **no investigation agency of its own**; it relies on the **CBI**.

INTRO & ORIGIN

 States must establish Lokayuktas under **Section 63**, but the **design varies** — never universalise a Governor–HC-Chief-Justice panel or a fixed tenure to all Lokayuktas.

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

5.12 FACTUAL-RISK AND CURRENT-STATUS CONTROLS: RECALL MAP

5.12 Factual-risk and current-status controls

V

Dimension 1
 States must establish Lokayuktas under Section 63, but the design varies — never universalise a Governor–HC-Chief-Justice panel or a fixed tenure to

Dimension 2
 The 2016 amendment changed the asset-declaration rule (Section 44), easing the form/timeline — attribute it correctly; do not confuse it with a juri

Dimension 3
 The Prevention of Corruption Act, 1988 was amended in 2018 to add the Section 17A prior-approval requirement — a statute, in force; do not attach an

Dimension 4
 Justice A.M. Khanwilkar has chaired the Lokpal since 10 Mar 2024; the first chair was Justice P.C. Ghose (2019). The higher-judiciary jurisdiction q

STATIC THEORY

- □ The **2016 amendment** changed the **asset-declaration** rule (Section 44), easing the form/timeline — attribute it correctly; do not confuse it with a jurisdiction change.

- □ The **Prevention of Corruption Act, 1988** was **amended in 2018** to add the **Section 17A prior-approval** requirement — a statute, in force; do not attach an unverified current-litigation status.

- □ **Justice A.M. Khanwilkar** has chaired the Lokpal since **10 Mar 2024**; the first chair was **Justice P.C. Ghose (2019)**. The **higher-judiciary jurisdiction** question is **stayed and unresolved (SC, 20 Feb 2025)** — do not present it as settled.

- □□ Do not fabricate complaint/disposal statistics or exact preliminary-inquiry/investigation month-limits where sources differ; state the 7-year complaint limitation and the mechanism.

- less than !-- BEGIN GENERATED PYQ INTEGRATION: 2024-2025 -→

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. States must establish Lokayuktas under **Section 63**, but the **design varies** — never universalise a Governor–HC-Chief-Justice panel or a fixed tenure to all Lokayuktas.

2. The **2016 amendment** changed the **asset-declaration** rule (Section 44), easing the form/timeline — attribute it correctly; do not confuse it with a jurisdiction change.

3. The **Prevention of Corruption Act, 1988** was **amended in 2018** to add the **Section 17A prior-approval** requirement — a statute, in force; do not attach an unverified current-litigation status.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK
Lokpal & Lokayuktas — The Ombudsman in India — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 5.12 Factual-risk and current-status controls

HIGH

Foundation · Recent PYQ Integration (2024-2025)

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured comparison from the foundation source layer.

KEY DATA

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2025	Prelims GS-I	98	Lokpal - jurisdiction and composition	Objective question; official Set-A key available locally, answer not inferred	Key available locally (official Set-A answer key present); answer not recorded here	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK
Lokpal & Lokayuktas — The Ombudsman in India — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Recent PYQ Integration (2024-2025)

HIGH

Foundation · Recent PYQ Integration (2024-2025)

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Exam-ready treatment of Recent PYQ Integration (2024-2025).

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MAINS ANGLE

Status: *2024-2025 question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner.* ***Provenance:*** *Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-PRELIMS-2024-2025.md.* ***Answer-key rule:*** *The official 2024-2025 Prelims Set-A keys are present in the repository and CSAT Set-A keys are supplied; even so, no option or answer is recorded or inferred in this integration.* ***Years represented:*** *2025* ***Paper(s):*** *Prelims GS-I* ***Routed question demands:*** *1*

STUDY LINK

Lokpal & Lokayuktas — The Ombudsman in India — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Recent PYQ Integration (2024-2025)

HIGH

Foundation · What this owner must now support

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Lokpal - jurisdiction and composition

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

WHAT THIS OWNER MUST NOW SUPPORT: RECALL MAP

What this owner must now support

V

Dimension 1 Lokpal - jurisdiction and composition	**Dimension 2** This block integrates the 2024-2025 examinable demand and paper metadata. It is kept separate from the 2018-2023 block and does not convert an unkeyed
Dimension 3 less than !-- END GENERATED PYQ INTEGRATION: 2024-2025 -→	

STATIC THEORY

- This block integrates the 2024-2025 examinable demand and paper metadata. It is kept separate from the 2018-2023 block and does not convert an unkeyed/answer-free objective question into a solved answer.

- less than !-- END GENERATED PYQ INTEGRATION: 2024-2025 -→

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Lokpal & Lokayuktas — The Ombudsman in India — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → What this owner must now support

HIGH

Foundation · Semantic-completeness ownership and PYQ control

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Exam-ready treatment of Semantic-completeness ownership and PYQ control.

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MAINS ANGLE

Status and source: *Lokpal is a statutory body under the Lokpal and Lokayuktas Act, 2013 (Act 1 of 2014), read with the 2016 amendment, Complaint Rules, 2020 and applicable administrative/recruitment rules. It is neither a constitutional court nor a general grievance commission.* ***Current roster, checked 5 September 2026:*** *Justice Ajay Manikrao Khanwilkar is Chairperson. The official present-member pages list judicial members Justice L. Narayana Swamy, Justice Sanjay Yadav and Justice Ritu Raj Awasthi, and members Sushil Chandra, Pankaj Kumar and Ajay Tirkey. No occupant is invented for an unfilled statutory seat.* ***Composition and representation:*** *Chairperson plus not more than eight Members; at least fifty per cent of Members are judicial, and at least fifty per cent of Members must collectively come from the named SC/ST/OBC/minority/ women categories. The representation rule does not add seats.* ***Selection and tenure:*** *the statutory selection committee is PM, Lok Sabha Speaker, LoP, CJI/nominee and eminent jurist. A Search Committee assists. The President appoints. Term is five years or age seventy, whichever is earlier, without reappointment; statutory removal safeguards apply.* ***Jurisdiction:*** *covered persons include the PM subject to special filters, Union Ministers, MPs, Groups A-D officials, former covered public servants and qualifying government-linked/donation/foreign-contribution entities. Parliamentary speech and vote remain constitutionally protected.* ***Prime-Minister safeguards:*** *excluded subject matters, full-bench screening, two-thirds approval, in-camera proceedings and confidentiality qualify the ordinary complaint route. Coverage is not equivalent to an unrestricted investigation power.* ***Process and powers:*** *complaint scrutiny may lead to preliminary inquiry or investigation, followed by disciplinary, sanction or prosecution directions within the Act. The Inquiry and Prosecution Wings, CVC and CBI remain distinct; guilt and punishment belong to the Special Court.* ***Limits:*** *the Act does not create a general suo-motu grievance power; the seven-year limitation, statutory procedure, natural justice and judicial review remain. The 2016 asset-return amendment must not be confused with restoration of the original public-disclosure form.* ***Judges and State variation:*** *the Supreme Court stayed the Lokpal's 27 January 2025 High Court-judge jurisdiction order on 20 February 2025; no final merits proposition is asserted. Section 63 requires State establishment, but each Lokayukta's composition, appointment, jurisdiction and powers depend on its own State law.* ***PYQ/case firewall:*** *Common Cause (2017) prevented implementation delay; Lok Prahari concerns electoral disclosure; Sita Soren (2024) rejects bribery immunity under legislative privilege. The direct 2025 Prelims Lokpal composition/jurisdiction demand is owned here; no direct Mains PYQ is invented.*

STUDY LINK

Lokpal & Lokayuktas — The Ombudsman in India — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Semantic-completeness ownership and PYQ control

HIGH

Advanced · Core Foundation

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Subject: Polity · **Tier:** Advanced (exam depth) · **GS Paper:** GS-II

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

CORE FOUNDATION: RECALL MAP

Core Foundation

V

Dimension 1 Subject: Polity · Tier: Advanced (exam depth) · GS Paper: GS-II	**Dimension 2** Grounded in: Indian Polity by M. Laxmikant, Ch. 61 (direct check of the local Sixth Revised Edition PDF) + official updates.
Dimension 3 □ = from source book · □□ = inference / analysis · □ = official/court-verified update.	**Dimension 4** Companion: basic/Lokpal-and-Lokayuktas.md.

STATIC THEORY

- **Grounded in:** Indian Polity by M. Laxmikant, Ch. 61 (direct check of the local Sixth Revised Edition PDF) + official updates.

- □ = from source book · □□ = inference / analysis · □ = official/court-verified update.

- *Companion: basic/Lokpal-and-Lokayuktas.md.*

- □□ **Note:** Lokpal & Lokayuktas are **statutory** bodies (Lokpal and Lokayuktas Act, **2013**) — **NOT constitutional**.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. = from source book · □□ = inference / analysis · □ = official/court-verified update.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Lokpal & Lokayuktas — The Ombudsman in India — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Core Foundation

HIGH

Advanced · PART A — BACKGROUND □

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

□ **Ombudsman** first created in **Sweden (1809)**; India's version recommended by the **First ARC (1966–70)** →

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

PART A — BACKGROUND □: RECALL MAP

PART A — BACKGROUND □

V

Dimension 1 □ Ombudsman first created in Sweden (1809); India's version recommended by the First ARC (1966–70) →	**Dimension 2** Lokpal (Centre) + Lokayukta (states).
Dimension 3 □ ARC kept the judiciary outside Lokpal's purview (like New Zealand; unlike Sweden).	**Dimension 4** □ Ten bills introduced (1968 → Dec 2011) before the law finally passed → Lokpal and Lokayuktas Act, 2013

STATIC THEORY

- **Lokpal** (Centre) + **Lokayukta** (states).
- □ ARC kept the **judiciary outside** Lokpal's purview (like New Zealand; unlike Sweden).
- □ **Ten** bills introduced (1968 → Dec 2011) before the law finally passed → **Lokpal and Lokayuktas Act, 2013**
- (□□ catalysed by the **2011 Anna Hazare / India Against Corruption** movement).

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. **Ombudsman** first created in **Sweden (1809)**; India's version recommended by the **First ARC (1966–70)** →
2. ARC kept the **judiciary outside** Lokpal's purview (like New Zealand; unlike Sweden).
3. **Ten** bills introduced (1968 → Dec 2011) before the law finally passed → **Lokpal and Lokayuktas Act, 2013**

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Lokpal & Lokayuktas — The Ombudsman in India — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → PART A — BACKGROUND □

HIGH

Advanced · PART B — LOKPAL (Centre) □□

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Exam-ready treatment of PART B — LOKPAL (Centre) □□.

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Lokpal & Lokayuktas — The Ombudsman in India — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → PART B — LOKPAL (Centre) □□

HIGH

Advanced · Composition □

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured comparison from the advanced source layer.

KEY DATA

Point	Detail
□ Structure	**Chairperson + max 8 members**; **50% must be judicial members**
□ Reservation	**not less than 50%** of members from **SC/ST/OBC/minorities/women**
□ Chair eligibility	Ex-CJI / ex-SC judge / eminent person of integrity & expertise (anti-corruption/PA/law/finance)

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Lokpal & Lokayuktas — The Ombudsman in India — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Composition □

HIGH

Advanced · Selection □

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

□ **Selection Committee = PM (chair) + Speaker (LS) + LoP (LS) + CJI/SC judge + an eminent jurist** (nominated by the President on the first four's advice). A **Search Committee** (also 50% SC/ST/OBC/min/women) assists.

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Selection Committee = PM (chair) + Speaker (LS) + LoP (LS) + CJI/SC judge + an eminent jurist (nominated by the President on the first four's advice). A **Search Committee** (also 50% SC/ST/OBC/min/women) assists.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Lokpal & Lokayuktas — The Ombudsman in India — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Selection □

HIGH

Advanced · Jurisdiction □

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

□ **PM** (with safeguards/exclusions — atomic energy, space, security, public order, foreign relations), **Ministers, MPs**, and **Groups A/B/C/D** officials. Also covers specified bodies **established, controlled or financed by government, subject to the statutory conditions** and **FCRA recipients greater than ₹10 lakh/yr**.

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

JURISDICTION □: RECALL MAP

Jurisdiction □

V

Dimension 1 □ PM (with safeguards/exclusions — atomic energy, space, security, public order, foreign relations), Ministers, MPs, and Groups A/B/C/D officials. Als	**Dimension 2** □ Power of superintendence & direction over any agency incl. the CBI for referred cases.
Dimension 3 □ Timelines: preliminary enquiry 3 (+3) months; investigation 6 (+6); trial 1 (+1) yr via special courts.	**Dimension 4** □ Can attach/confiscate corruptly-acquired property; grants sanction for prosecution.

STATIC THEORY

- □ **Power of superintendence & direction over any agency incl. the CBI** for referred cases.
- □ **Timelines:** preliminary enquiry 3 (+3) months; investigation 6 (+6); trial 1 (+1) yr via **special courts**.
- □ Can **attach/confiscate** corruptly-acquired property; grants **sanction for prosecution**.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. **PM** (with safeguards/exclusions — atomic energy, space, security, public order, foreign relations), **Ministers, MPs**, and **Groups A/B/C/D** officials. Also covers specified bodies **established, controlled or financed by government, subject to the statutory conditions** and **FCRA recipients greater than ₹10 lakh/yr**.
2. **Power of superintendence & direction over any agency incl. the CBI** for referred cases.
3. **Timelines:** preliminary enquiry 3 (+3) months; investigation 6 (+6); trial 1 (+1) yr via **special courts**.
4. Can **attach/confiscate** corruptly-acquired property; grants **sanction for prosecution**.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Lokpal & Lokayuktas — The Ombudsman in India — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Jurisdiction □

HIGH

Advanced · Drawbacks □ (UPSC favourite)

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Exam-ready treatment of Drawbacks □ (UPSC favourite).

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: **No suo-motu** power · emphasis on **form over substance** of complaint · **no anonymous** complaints · heavy punishment for false complaints (deterrent) · **7-year** limitation · non-transparent PM-complaint procedure.

CORRECT: Recheck the precise constitutional rule, exception, or institutional limit.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Lokpal & Lokayuktas — The Ombudsman in India — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Drawbacks (UPSC favourite)

HIGH

Advanced · PART C — LOKAYUKTAS (States)

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

 First established in **Maharashtra (1971)** (Odisha enacted 1970 but enforced 1983).

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

PART C — LOKAYUKTAS (STATES) : RECALL MAP

**PART C — LOKAYUKTAS (States) **

V

Dimension 1 First established in Maharashtra (1971) (Odisha enacted 1970 but enforced 1983).	**Dimension 2** The 2013 Act required states to establish Lokayuktas by state law and left the
Dimension 3 design to them. Appointment panel, composition, jurisdiction, tenure, age limits, removal and the existence of an Upalokayukta therefore vary across s	

STATIC THEORY

- The 2013 Act required states to establish Lokayuktas **by state law** and left the

- design to them. Appointment panel, composition, jurisdiction, tenure, age limits, removal and the existence of an Upalokayukta therefore vary across state enactments.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. First established in **Maharashtra (1971)** (Odisha enacted 1970 but enforced 1983).

2. The 2013 Act required states to establish Lokayuktas **by state law** and left the

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Lokpal & Lokayuktas — The Ombudsman in India — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → PART C — LOKAYUKTAS (States)

HIGH

Advanced · UPSC Traps

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

state statutes differ.

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Lokpal is a constitutional body

CORRECT: statutory (2013 Act).

WRONG: Lokpal has unlimited members

CORRECT: Chair + max 8 (50% judicial).

WRONG: The PM is fully outside Lokpal's ambit

CORRECT: included, with subject-matter exclusions.

WRONG: Lokpal can act **suo motu**

CORRECT: cannot (a key drawback).

WRONG: Ombudsman originated in the UK

CORRECT: Sweden (1809).

WRONG: Every Lokayukta follows one Governor–Chief Justice–LoP panel and 5-year/65 rule

CORRECT:

WRONG: The 2025 stayed Lokpal order finally settled higher-judiciary coverage

CORRECT: no; the Supreme Court stay is interim and the merits remain unresolved.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Lokpal & Lokayuktas — The Ombudsman in India — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → UPSC Traps

HIGH

Advanced · □ CA hooks (official/court-verified)

GS-II Indian Polity

NEWS TRIGGER

□ **Justice A.M. Khanwilkar** is the current **Lokpal Chairperson** (assumed office **10 Mar 2024**); the **first** Lokpal chair was **Justice Pinaki Chandra Ghose (2019)**. □ □ On **20 Feb 2025**, the Supreme Court stayed the Lokpal's 27 Jan 2025 order

INTRO & ORIGIN

asserting jurisdiction over a High Court judge. The jurisdiction issue remains unresolved; the stayed order is not settled law.

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

□ CA HOOKS (OFFICIAL/COURT-VERIFIED): RECALL MAP

□ CA hooks (official/court-verified)

V

Dimension 1 asserting jurisdiction over a High Court judge. The jurisdiction issue remains unresolved; the stayed order is not settled law.	**Dimension 2** □ Lokpal has notified complaint-processing procedures and maintains inquiry/prosecution
Dimension 3 machinery; avoid unsupported claims about sharp complaint growth or proposed amendments.	

STATIC THEORY

- □ Lokpal has notified complaint-processing procedures and maintains inquiry/prosecution

- machinery; avoid unsupported claims about sharp complaint growth or proposed amendments.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Lokpal & Lokayuktas — The Ombudsman in India — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → □ CA hooks (official/court-verified)

HIGH

Advanced · Mains angles

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Exam-ready treatment of Mains angles.

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MAINS ANGLE

"An Ombudsman without teeth" — evaluate the structural weaknesses of the Lokpal (no suo-motu, PM safeguards, delays). Can the Lokpal investigate the higher judiciary? Discuss in light of the 2025 SC stay. Multiplicity of anti-corruption institutions (Lokpal, CVC, CBI, ED) — overlap and the need for coordination.

STUDY LINK

Lokpal & Lokayuktas — The Ombudsman in India — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Mains angles

End of Register Notes - UPSC Agent / Copilot CLI